Artifacts

The artifacts presented here are provided as examples. Use them as guides when creating your own artifacts, or modify them as you see fit.

Lycan's Bane

Weapon (longsword), artifact (requires attunement)
This sword was created by the paladins of Lunum, the moon god. This sword was created to fight the swarms of werewolves that were destroying the land. This sword has a gem in its pommel that is clear, round, and glows in a way that emulates the phases of the moon. The blade itself is silver, seeming to glow with faint moonlight.

This longsword deals an additional 2d6 radiant damage when it hits. When used against a creature afflicted with the curse of lycanthropy, attack rolls against it are made with advantage. Additionally, the first time a creature afflicted with lycanthropy is hit with this weapon, it automatically becomes a critical hit.

Silver Weapon. Lycan's Bane is a silvered weapon.

Silver Salvation. Lycan's Bane holds 5 charges. A charge can be expended to activate one of the following abilities:

- You pray to the moon god Lunum with the blade in hand, and your senses open, allowing you to identify all creatures with the curse of lycanthropy within a 60-foot radius.
- You hold the flat of the blade to the heart of a willing or incapacitated creature that has the lycanthropic curse, drawing the affliction from their body and curing them. Removing the curse this way takes 1 minute.
- You hold Lycan's Bane up to the sky, pommel up. The clear gem will shine with a faint white light, turning werewolves nearby. Creatures afflicted by lycanthropy that are within 30 feet of you have disadvantage on attack roll while in this radius. Each affected creature also suffers the effects of the *bane* spell, and must succeed a DC 16 Charisma saving throw or become frightened of you for 1 minute.

Lycan's Bane regains all expended charges daily at each moonrise.

The sword is powerless on moonless nights. All evil creatures with the curse of lycanthropy that see you with this sword will be openly hostile to you and those in your immediate party.

Destroying Lycan's Bane. The sword can only be destroyed using a dark ritual which can only take place on a moonless night. The ritual involves sprinkling the blood of 3 willing creatures with any type of lycanthropy on the blade while whispering the correct incantations. This ritual leaves the blade magicless and vulnerable, allowing it to be melted down in a fire - though if the sword is recovered before this occurs, a priest of Lunum can restore its magic by conferring his blessing.

Sworn Pactbreaker

Weapon (war scythe), artifact (requires attunement)
Legend says that the Sworn Pactbreaker was wielded by the champion of the Thalyot family for over a century, dispatching justice and freeing enslaved peoples from blood pacts with demons, devils, and other evil outsiders, typically by destroying the demons responsible. This incredibly sleek black scythe sports a sturdy blood red oak shaft, and its blade is made up of a jagged, razor sharp edge that calls to mind the teeth of a fearsome dragon.

Before attuning to the weapon, the prospective wielder must survive three trials.

- ***The First Trial.*** Upon first holding the scythe, a wellspring of voices resonates in the wielder's head, chanting loudly and violently in multiple languages, "Cut the ties. Set them free. Break the bonds." The chanting lasts for up to an hour, starting off barely audible but growing louder with every passing minute. The wielder must make a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw to withstand the overwhelming pressure of these voices. On a failed save, they are deemed unworthy and immediately drop the weapon at their feet; they are unable to wield the Sworn Pactbreaker, let alone touch it. This effect lasts for 1d4 + 2 days, upon which the creature can try again.
- ***The Second Trial.*** Upon successfully passing the first trial, a single, sharp voice will speak directly to the wielder, asking them what the purpose of the Sworn Pactbreaker is. Only the correct answer - judged by the DM - will allow them to succeed the trial, though if the wielder is of evil alignment, there is no possibility of a correct response. An incorrect response will cause the wielder to be deemed unworthy, suffering the effects as above.
- ***The Third Trial.*** The scythe speaks to the wielder again, giving them a mission to free a citizen from their bond with a lesser demon. The wielder must kill or banish the demon to pass the third trial; only then will they finally attune to the weapon and unlock its full potential.

Once attuned, the wielder of the Sworn Pactbreaker gains the following benefits:

Righteous Judgment. The Sworn Pactbreaker deals an additional 2d10 radiant damage on a hit. If the target is of evil alignment (lawful evil, neutral evil, or chaotic evil), it deals another 1d10 radiant damage on a hit.

Champion of the Pactbreaker. Your Strength and Dexterity scores each increase by 2, to a maximum of 20.

Sentience. The weapon is imbued with the consciousness of its previous wielders. The collective consciousness speaks to the current wielder, teaching and guiding their actions to make them truly worthy to hold the blade.

Destroying the Sworn Pactbreaker. Only a Demon Lord can truly destroy the Sworn Pactbreaker. This can be done by defeating its wielder in combat, then lighting it ablaze with hellfire.



Armor Set of the Tyrant

Ages ago, a man called Cyprus the Divine ruled over a vast human kingdom. He possessed a great power that seemed to come from the divine, allowing him to very nearly match them in power. He was named the God King, and he was an unstoppable general, generous leader and a humble man. Countless races and factions banded together to attempt to overthrow Cyprus and obtain his overwhelming power for themselves, but every army that came was defeated before they could even reach him.

While he was seen as a god, he was still mortal and human. He eventually grew old, and the constant war made him paranoid. He foresaw the existence of Ascendants, people prophesied by the gods to succeed Cyprus in his rule. Fearing the loss of his power and return to mortality and death, he searched frantically for these Ascendants, claiming the gods decieved him and that they would destroy him and his kingdom. His methods grew increasingly brutal, including mass executions and razing of villages, killing every Ascendant he could get his hands on save for one - his son, Alexander, the man Cyprus saw fit to properly succeed him after his passing.

Alexander came of age some time after Cyprus's death, and sought to become the next to be called Divine, like his father. To accomplish this goal, he learned that an Ascendant had to "become one with all... to give up everything, and take everything." He tried, as did other Ascendants who survived Cyprus's wrath, and all have failed. What the old king failed to mention was that the key to manifesting his power lay in the armor that he had always worn. With its pieces scattered to the winds, Alexander began his new quest, leading an army of magisters on a hunt for his father's legendary suit of armor.

Stride of the Tyrant

Wondrous item, artifact

These black and silver armored boots carry the weight of a terrible power with each stride. While wearing these boots, your Constitution score increases by 2, as does your maximum for that score.

Curse. When wearing these boots, you feel that your steps are being pulled in another direction. Your speed is reduced by half while wearing these boots. Additionally, during a short or long rest, roll a d100. On a roll of 90-99, you wake from your rest 1d10 x 100 feet away from where you made camp in a random direction. On a roll of 100, you wake 1 mile from your camp in a random direction without making a sound.

Eyes of the Tyrant

Wondrous item, artifact

This black and silver helmet has a visor that shields your face. When you look through it, your eyes appear to have turned a fiery red. While wearing the helmet, your Strength score increases by 2, as does your maximum for that score, and you gain resistance to fire damage.

Curse. While wearing this helmet, you feel your body temperature begin to rise. The heat is unnerving, but becomes natural the longer you wear the helmet, to the point that being without that heat physically harms you. You gain vulnerability to cold damage. If you remove the helmet, your cold vulnerability remains for 1d4 days.

Tracks of the Tyrant

Wondrous item, artifact

This set of silken garments is enchanted to remain perfectly clean and sizes perfectly to fit your body. Despite this, wearing it causes a shiver to run through your entire body. While wearing the helmet, your gain resistance to lightning damage and your speed increases by 10 feet.

Curse. Despite the lightness of the garment, it feels as if wearing it makes you feel like something is missing. You gain one level of exhaustion while wearing it. This level of exhaustion cannot be removed except if you possess two more pieces of the Tyrant's armor. A spell such as greater restoration can suppress this level of exhaustion for 4 hours.

Heart of the Tyrant

Armor (half plate), artifact

This black and silver armor fills you with immense heat and power as you don it, as every movement threatens to unleash it upon your foes. Your melee attacks deal 1d6 additional fire damage on a hit.

Curse. This fire is hard to control, and bursts painfully from your body without warning at the slightest disturbance. Whenever you are hit with an attack or spell, you take an additional 1d6 fire damage.

Dukes of the Tyrant

Wondrous item, artifact

These black and silver gauntlets fill you with an oddly comforting warmth, despite their harsh appearance. There is a small notch on the ring finger of one of the gauntlets, and the longer you stare at that spot, the more you feel that something is meant to fit there. While wearing these gloves, you lose vulnerability to cold damage and gain resistance to cold damage.

Curse. The warmth, though beneficial at times, seems to turn your stomach. You are permanently subjected to the poisoned condition. This condition cannot be removed except by obtaining the Ring of the Tyrant or by a wish spell.

Ring of the Tyrant

Ring, artifact

As you don this ring, you feel as if a terrible weight has been lifted. You stand up, filled with renewed vigor. You feel... that you could conquer the world. While wearing this ring, your Constitution score increases by 2.

Curse. While you wear the ring, you find yourself unable and unwilling to take it off. It cannot be removed except by the wish spell. Additionally, you find yourself driven to find the other pieces of the Tyrant's armor, if you do not have them already. Finally completing the set fills you with the power and spirit of a long-deceased warlord who ruled entire realms. The curses from the other pieces of the Tyrant's armor no longer affect you, as long as you are wearing the entire set. However, if you lose a single piece of this armor, all of your ability scores are reduced to 10 until you reclaim the missing piece. Additionally, you gain the following flaw: "My armor is more valuable than my life. I must protect it at all costs."